Vishakha Shukla, Ph.D.

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Academic Employment

Postdoctoral Fellow 2026–
Facial Affective and Communicative Expressions Lab (PI: Ruth Grossman)
Emerson College, Boston, MA

Education

Ph.D. in Communicative Sciences and Disorders 2021–2026
New York University, New York, NY

M.A. in Linguistics 2016–2018
Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India

B.A. (Hons) in English 2013–2016
English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India

Publications

Under Review

[1] **Shukla**, **V.**, He, A. X., & Arunachalam, S. (under revision, second round). *Tuning of unscripted parent narratives directed to autistic and non-autistic children: An exploratory eye-tracking study.*

[2] **Shukla**, **V.**, Jaswal, V., & Arunachalam, S. (under review). *Impact of accommodated speech on autistic adults' comprehension and evaluation of the speaker.*

Published

[3] **Shukla**, **V.**, Jaswal, V., & Arunachalam, S. (2026). Linguistic accommodation made by non-autistic speakers in response to being told the listener is autistic. *Acta Psychologica*, *269*, 107434.

[4] Arunachalam, S., Carroll, L., Lee, R., Luyster, R., Margolis, B., & **Shukla**, **V.** (2026). Autistic parents and autistic children: Using the double empathy model in the context of language use and development. In Y. Ortega, M. B. Rosa, S. Canagrajah, & N. Walker (Eds.), *Handbook of neurodiversity and applied linguistics*. Routledge. [author order is alphabetical].

[5] Ben-Ami, S., **Shukla**, **V.**, Gupta, P., Shah, P., Ralekar, C., Ganesh, S., Gilad-Gutnick, S., Rubio-Fernández, P., & Sinha, P. (2024). Form perception as a bridge to real-world functional proficiency. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, *46*.

[6] Rubio-Fernandez, P., Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., Mahapatra, A., Ralekar, C., Ben-Ami, S., & Sinha, P. (2023). Multimodal communication in newly sighted children: An investigation of the relation between visual experience and pragmatic development. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, *46*.

[7] **Shukla**, **V.**, Long, M., & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2022). Children's acquisition of new/given markers in english, hindi, mandinka and spanish: Exploring the effect of optionality during grammaticalization. *Glossa Psycholinguistics*, *1*(1).

[8] Rubio-Fernandez, P., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., Ben-Ami, S., & Sinha, P. (2022). Head turning is an effective cue for gaze following: Evidence from newly sighted individuals, school children and adults. *Neuropsychologia*, *174*, 108330.

[9] Rubio-Fernandez, P., Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, Bhatia, V., & Sinha, P. (2022). Visual perspective taking is not automatic in a simplified dot task: Evidence from newly sighted children, primary school children and adults. *Neuropsychologia*, 108256.

[10] **Shukla**, **V.**, Long, M., Bhatia, V., & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2021). Some sentences prime pragmatic reasoning in the verification and evaluation of comparisons. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*.

[11] Long, M., **Shukla**, **V.**, & Rubio-Fernandez, P. (2021). The development of simile comprehension: From similarity to scalar implicature. *Child Development*, *92*(4), 1439–1457.

[12] Yadav, H., Vaidya, A., **Shukla**, **V.**, & Husain, S. (2020). Word order typology interacts with linguistic complexity: A cross-linguistic corpus study. *Cognitive Science*, *44*(4), e12822.

Conference Presentations

- **Impact of accommodated speech on autistic people's evaluation of the speaker** Boston, USA, 2026
  Vishakha Shukla, Vikram Jaswal, Sudha Arunachalam
  Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Linguistic accommodation in autistic and non-autistic dyads in response to "autism" label** New Orleans, USA, 2026
  Vishakha Shukla, Vikram Jaswal, Sudha Arunachalam
  Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting
- **Attention to illustrations in autistic and non-autistic children following spontaneous parent narratives: An exploratory eye-tracking study** Nijmegen, The Netherlands, 2023
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  Many Paths to Language
- **Multimodal referential communication in newly-sighted children: When do they look at their interlocutor's face?** Nijmegen, The Netherlands, 2023
  Vrinda Bhatia, Vishakha Shukla, Anwesha Mahapatra, Madeleine Long, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
- **Parental tuning of narratives directed to autistic and non-autistic children: An exploratory eye-tracking study** Durham, USA, 2023
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  Meeting on Language in Autism
- **Comprehension of unscripted parent narratives by autistic children** Wisconsin, USA, 2022
  Vishakha Shukla, Angela Xiaoxue He, Sudha Arunachalam
  2022 Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders
- **Eliciting narratives in diferent languages, cultures and platforms: methodological insights.** Virtual, 2021
  Vrinda Bhatia, Anwesha Mahapatra, Vishakha Shukla, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  MODE: Methods of Online Discourse Elicitation Conference
- **Children's acquisition of new/given markers in English, Hindi, Mandinka and Spanish** Virtual, 2021
  Vishakha Shukla, Madeleine Long, Vrinda Bhatia, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  34th CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Priming pragmatic reasoning in the verification and evaluation of comparisons** Virtual, 2021
  Vishakha Shukla, Madeleine Long, Vrinda Bhatia, Paula Rubio-Fernandez
  34th CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Perspective taking in newly-sighted kids** Boulder, USA, 2019
  Paula Rubio-Fernandez, Vishakha Shukla, Shlomit Ben Ami, Chetan Ralekar, Ashwini Vaidya, Michelle Oraa Ali, Pawan Sinha
  32nd CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing
- **Cross-linguistic comparison of crossing dependencies using psycho-linguistically motivated measures** Hyderabad, India, 2018

Vishakha Shukla, Himanshu Yadav, Ashwini Vaidya, and Samar Husain
AMLaP-Asia

Teaching and Work Experience

Speech and Language Development — NYU Communicative Sciences and Disorders
Adjunct Professor — Spring, 2025

Science of Language — NYU Communicative Sciences and Disorders
Teaching Assistant — Fall 2023, 2024, 2025

First Language Acquisition — NYU Linguistics
Teaching Assistant — Spring 2023

Project Prakash, MIT — New Delhi, India
Research Assistant — 2018-2021

Fellowships and Awards

- Steinhardt Dissertation Finishing Award — 2025
- Steinhardt Research & Travel Grant, NYU — 2024,2025
- Travel Bursary, Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics — 2023
- Student Travel Award, SRCLD — 2023

Service

- Member of Committee for Considerations for Autistic Populations, ASHA (2023)
- Founded Neurodiversity Journal Club at CSD, NYU
- Undergraduate research mentor SHARE-CSD (2023, 2024)